Share Our Wealth

Senator Huey P. Long · February 5, 1934

Source: Huey P. Long, "Share Our Wealth" ("Carry Out the Command of the Lord"), Congressional Record, February 5, 1934. Public domain (U.S. government record). Complete text.

> Louisiana's Senator Long proposed capping great fortunes and guaranteeing every family a basic share of the nation's wealth — a populist challenge from the left that pressured FDR to expand the New Deal.

COMPLETE TEXT — UNEDITED

Mr. Long: Mr. President, I send to the desk and ask to have printed in the RECORD not a speech but what is more in the nature of an appeal to the people of America.

People of America: In every community get together at once and organize a share-our-wealth society — Motto: Every man a king.

Principles and platform:

To limit poverty by providing that every deserving family shall share in the wealth of America for not less than one third of the average wealth, thereby to possess not less than $5,000 free of debt.

To limit fortunes to such a few million dollars as will allow the balance of the American people to share in the wealth and profits of the land.

Old-age pensions of $30 per month to persons over 60 years of age who do not earn as much as $1,000 per year or who possess less than $10,000 in cash or property.

To limit the hours of work to such an extent as to prevent overproduction and to give the workers of America some share in the recreations, conveniences, and luxuries of life.

To balance agricultural production with what can be sold and consumed according to the laws of God, which have never failed.

To care for the veterans of our wars.

Taxation to run the Government to be supported, first, by reducing big fortunes from the top, thereby to improve the country and provide employment in public works.

To share our wealth by providing for every deserving family to have one third of the average wealth would mean that, at the worst, such a family could have a fairly comfortable home, an automobile, and a radio, with other reasonable home conveniences, and a place to educate their children. Through sharing the work, that is, by limiting the hours of toil so that all would share in what is made and produced in the land, every family would have enough coming in every year to feed, clothe, and provide a fair share of the luxuries of life to its members.

There is nothing wrong with the United States. We have more food than we can eat. We have more clothes and things out of which to make clothes than we can wear. We have more houses and lands than the whole 120 million can use if they all had good homes. So what is the trouble? Nothing except that a handful of men have everything and the balance of the people have nothing if their debts were paid. There should be every man a king in this land flowing with milk and honey instead of the lords of finance at the top and slaves and peasants at the bottom.

Motto: "Every man a king" conveys the great plan of God and of the Declaration of Independence, which said: "All men are created equal." It conveys that no one man is the lord of another, but that from the head to the foot of every man is carried his sovereignty.

Things cannot continue as they now are. America must take one of three choices, viz: A monarchy ruled by financial masters — a modern feudalism. Communism. Sharing of the wealth and income of the land among all the people by limiting the

hours of toil and limiting the size of fortunes. The Lord prescribed the last form. It would preserve all our gains, share them among our population, guarantee a greater country and a happy people.

Sincerely, Huey P. Long, United States Senator.